AI NOTES SERIES - PROMPT SHORTCUTS

Photo Editing Instructions

Ready-to-paste instruction prompts that tell an AI photo editor exactly what to change - and, just as important, what to keep exactly the same. Enhance a dull photo, blur or change the background, remove an unwanted object, restore an old photo and more.



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This is one shortcut from a series of separate student notes - one topic per PDF. Upload your photo to the AI tool first, then paste the instruction. Replace the words inside [square brackets] with your own details. Always keep your original photo safe - edit a copy, never the only copy.

Good Edits Start With Exact Words

An AI photo editor does not guess what you mean - it changes whatever your instruction leaves vague. "Make it better" can return a different face, different clothes and a different place. Exact words are what protect your photo.

The four parts of every good editing instruction

Part	What to write
1. Change	Name the one change: brighten the light, blur the background, remove the bottle on the left.
2. Keep the same	Name what must not move: the face, the clothes, the people, the writing in the photo.
3. Style	Say how natural it should look: natural and realistic, bright for printing, soft and warm.
4. Do not	Ban the common mistakes: do not change the face, do not add people, do not add text.

Six golden rules

1. **One change at a time.** Ask for brightness first, check it, then ask for the background. Five changes in one line gives you no way to fix one mistake.
2. **Always protect the face.** For any photo of a person, write "keep the face exactly the same" in every instruction, every time.
3. **Point with position words.** "The boy on the left", "the sign at the top" - position words tell the editor which thing you mean.
4. **Edit a copy.** Keep the original untouched in your phone. If an edit goes wrong, you can always start again.
5. **Check the small things.** After every edit, zoom in: fingers, ears, writing, logos and edges are where AI edits fail first.
6. **Fix, do not restart.** If one part is wrong, send a short follow-up naming only that part - page 6 shows how.

> **Which tool should you use?** Any AI tool that accepts a photo and an instruction works with this note - for example ChatGPT, Gemini and other AI image editors. Upload the photo first, then paste the instruction in the same chat. The words matter more than the tool.

The Master Prompt - One Template for Almost Any Edit

Copy this template, fill in the three brackets, and paste it under your uploaded photo. It works for most edits a student ever needs.

1. The master editing instruction

Best for: ChatGPT, Gemini, other AI editors

> Edit this photo: [describe the one change you want, for example: make the light brighter and the colours clearer]. Keep exactly the same: [the face and clothes of every person, and everything else in the photo]. Style: natural and realistic, like a good phone camera photo. Do not change any face, do not add or remove any person, and do not add any text.

Tip: Keep the "do not" line in every edit. It costs five seconds and prevents the most common AI mistake - a face that no longer looks like the person.

Why this template works

- **It asks for one change.** One clear job gets a clean result; a list of jobs gets a mixed one.
- **It locks the rest of the photo.** Naming what stays the same stops the editor redrawing things you liked.
- **It sets a natural style.** "Natural and realistic" stops the plastic, over-smooth look AI edits often produce.
- **It bans new text.** AI is poor at writing inside pictures - added words usually come out misspelled.

Change a photo, or make a new one?

Use an **editing instruction** when you already have a real photo and want it improved - the result is still your photo. Use a **creation prompt** (the picture-prompt notes in this series) when no photo exists yet. Never present an AI-created or heavily changed picture as a real photo of a real event - see the honesty box on the last page.

> **Make it yours in ten seconds:** change only the first bracket - the change you want. The keep-the-same list, the natural style and the do-not line can stay exactly the same for every photo, all year.

Eight Ready-to-Paste Instructions (1-4)

Upload your photo, paste one instruction, check the result, then - only if you need it - paste the next one.

2. Enhance a dull photo

Best for: Gemini, ChatGPT

> Enhance this photo: fix the dull light, balance the colours, sharpen the details slightly and remove the grey, washed-out look. Keep every person, face, object and the background exactly the same. Result should look natural, like the same photo taken on a sunny day with a better camera.

Tip: This is the safest first edit for almost any photo - school events, family pictures and old phone photos.

3. Blur the background (portrait look)

Best for: ChatGPT, Gemini

> Blur the background of this photo softly, like a portrait taken with a professional camera. Keep the person in front fully sharp and completely unchanged - same face, same clothes, same pose. Do not change the colours of the person.

Tip: Check the edges of hair and shoulders after this edit - that is where blur mistakes show first.

4. Remove an unwanted object or person

Best for: Gemini, ChatGPT

> Remove [the plastic bottle on the left / the person standing at the back] from this photo. Fill the empty space naturally with what would be behind it, matching the light and colours of the rest of the photo. Change nothing else at all.

Tip: Name the object and its position. "Remove the bottle" alone can remove the wrong bottle - or a hand holding one.

5. Change the background

Best for: ChatGPT, Gemini

> Replace the background of this photo with [a clean light-blue studio background / a green garden with soft sunlight]. Keep the person completely unchanged - same face, hair, clothes and pose, with natural light on the person that matches the new background. Do not add any other people or text.

Tip: Simple backgrounds (plain colour, garden, library) come out far better than busy famous places.

Eight Ready-to-Paste Instructions (5-8)

Four more jobs students ask for often - a clean ID-style photo, saving old family photos, colouring black-and-white pictures, and the careful "only one thing" edit.

6. Clean passport-style photo **Best for: Gemini, ChatGPT**

> Make this into a clean passport-style photo: plain white background, even bright light, head and shoulders only, face looking straight at the camera, natural and realistic. Keep the face 100% the same - same features, same skin tone, same expression. Do not beautify, slim or change the face in any way.

Tip: Use this for practice, profiles and school records. For official documents, follow the office or board rules - many only accept a studio photo, not an AI edit.

7. Restore an old or damaged photo **Best for: ChatGPT, Gemini**

> Restore this old photo: remove scratches, dust spots and folds, repair torn edges, and make faded faces clearer. Keep every face, person and detail true to the original - do not redraw faces, do not change clothes or the background scene, and do not add colour unless I ask for it.

Tip: Scan or photograph the old picture in bright, even light first. A flat, clear copy restores far better than a tilted, shadowy one.

8. Colour a black-and-white photo **Best for: Gemini, ChatGPT**

> Add natural, realistic colour to this black-and-white photo: true skin tones, natural colours for clothes and the surroundings, soft light like an old colour photograph. Keep every face, person, object and detail exactly the same - only add colour, change nothing else.

Tip: The AI guesses colours it cannot know - a uniform or a flag may come out the wrong colour. Say the known colours in your instruction.

9. Change only one thing **Best for: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude**

> Change only this one thing in the photo: [my shirt colour from white to light blue]. Absolutely everything else must stay pixel-for-pixel the same - same face, same background, same light, same other people and objects. If you are unsure what I mean, change less, not more.

Tip: This is the instruction to use after any edit that was 90% right - it protects the good 90% while you fix the rest.

Worked Example, Urdu Prompts and Honest Use

Worked example - a dull classroom photo

The photo: a class group photo taken indoors - faces are dark, colours look grey, and a water bottle sits in the front corner.

Step 1 - enhance (prompt 2): light and colours fixed, faces now clear. Checked: all faces still look like the real students.

Step 2 - remove one object (prompt 4): "Remove the water bottle in the front-left corner. Fill the space with the floor pattern. Change nothing else." Bottle gone, nothing else moved.

The result: the same real class photo, only brighter and cleaner - two small edits, checked one at a time.

When an edit goes too far - the fix-it line

> This edit changed too much. Go back to my original photo and make only this change: [name the single change]. Keep my face and everything else exactly as in the original.

Tip: Send this in the same chat, and re-upload the original photo with it if the tool has forgotten it.

Short instructions in Urdu also work

Most AI photo editors understand a simple Urdu instruction. Keep it short and name the keep-the-same parts, just like in English:

> Is photo ko roshan aur saaf karo. Kisi ka chehra, kapray aur background bilkul na badlo. Tasveer natural lagni chahiye, koi text na add karo.

Tip: The Roman Urdu line above means: brighten and clean this photo, do not change any face, clothes or background, keep it natural, add no text.

Honest use - read this before you share an edited photo.

Never edit a photo to make something look true that did not happen - no fake event photos, no putting a person somewhere they never were. Never edit ID cards, certificates, result cards or any official document photo. Small honest edits - light, colour, a cleaner background - are fine; changing what a photo proves is not.

Your practice task: take one dull photo of your own, run prompt 2, zoom in and check faces, fingers and writing, then try prompt 3. Two careful edits teach more than ten rushed ones.